THE KESSEL PATROL · ART BIBLE · EDITION 2.5

SNOW PATROL

KESSEL VALLEY

Storybook card stock over a working Colorado mountain. The canonical visual reference for the game as it ships today: interface, colour, type, characters, places, light and the rules for anything new.



NOVEMBER 2026 · SUPERSEDES EDITION 1 (THE DARK-SLATE KIT SHEET)

Every picture in this book is a frame of the running game unless it is tagged otherwise.

BEFORE YOU MAKE ANYTHING

How to use this book

One valley, two layers. Read the layer you are working in, check the values, and when this book and the game disagree, the game wins and this book gets rebuilt.

WHAT IS CANONICAL, IN ORDER

1. The running game: rockslide-game.vercel.app. It is the source of truth.

2. This book: every capture is a frame of that game; every colour value is read from its code by art/bible/tokens.ts.

3. art/README.md and the comments in src/: how things are built. Where their wording differs from this book, follow this book and fix them.

Edition 1 of this book (dark slate, Inter and JetBrains Mono, a ten-piece kit sheet) is retired. It no longer describes the game.

THE TWO LAYERS

The interface is storybook card stock: aubergine and burgundy cards, cream paper, tracked Jost capitals, Courier Prime for anything spoken. The world is a working Colorado mountain in winter: cobalt sky, cold granite, weathered timber, dark standing-seam roofs, tomato-red patrol kit. The interface never takes on the world's grit, and the world never takes on the interface's pastels.

USING IT FOR REVIEW

DesignCraft, PixelCraft and Claude Code reviews check new work against pages 4 to 7 (colour, type, shapes), 8 to 10 (interface), 11 and 12 (people) and 13 to 17 (places, light, markers). Page 19 is the checklist for new assets, and lists what must not come back.

HOW PICTURES ARE TAGGED

IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED	A frame of the running game, untouched. The approved reference.
STAGED IN ENGINE · APPROVED	The game's own models and renderer, arranged for the camera (a lineup, a close-up distance). Approved.
ILLUSTRATIVE · NOT A CAPTURE	Drawn for this book in DesignCraft: specimens, swatches, diagrams. Explains a rule; is not the game.
GENERATED FROM THE GAME'S CODE	Values read from the game's source by a script. Approved.
SHIPPED ASSET · APPROVED	A file the game ships (the emblem, the share card), shown as it is.
RETIRED · DO NOT USE	Shown only so it can be recognised and kept out.

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SOURCE art/bible/build_bible.py · art/bible/capture.mjs · art/bible/tokens.json

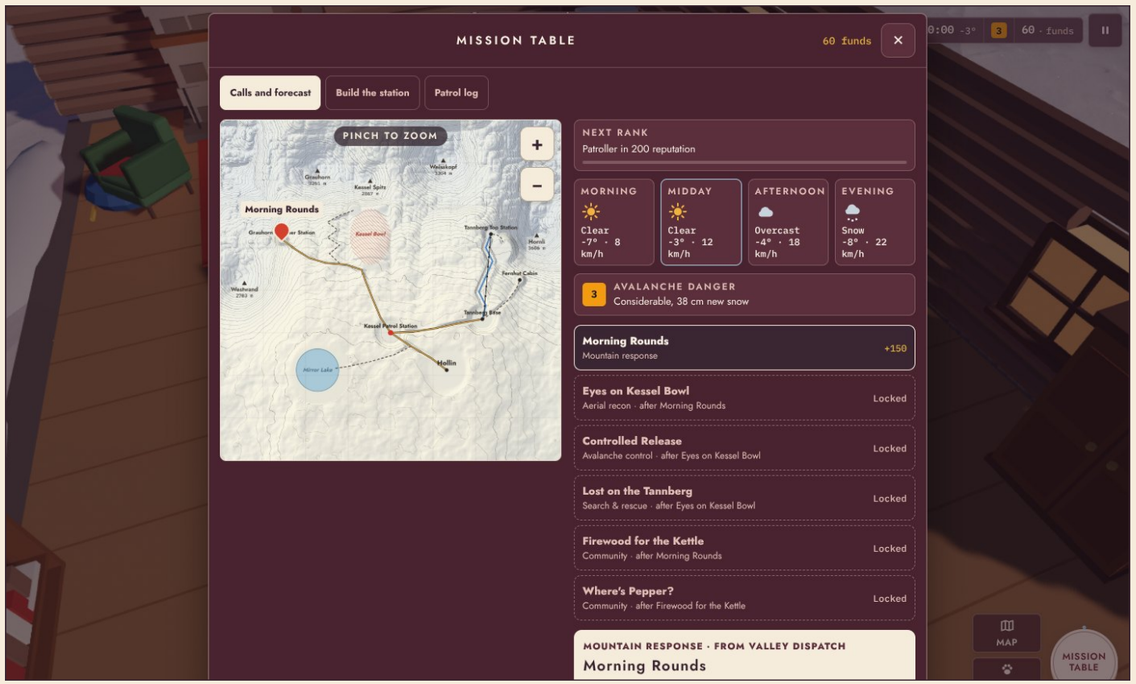
DIRECTION

Two layers, one valley

The patrol's paperwork is storybook; the mountain is real. That contrast is the look: a warm, hand-made interface laid over cold, honest weather.

THE INTERFACE

Storybook card stock



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED ui-board · the mission table: burgundy card, cream rules, tracked Jost, a paper topo map

- Aubergine and burgundy cards with a thin cream rule; cream paper for maps and primary buttons.
- Tracked Jost capitals for titles and labels; Courier Prime for the radio and anything said aloud.
- Colour only where it means something: red is the patrol and emergencies, mustard is caution, cyan is navigation and on, mint is done.
- Chapter cards in a soft family tone with a double ink frame.

THE WORLD

A working Colorado mountain



STAGED IN ENGINE · APPROVED env-air-hollin · Hollin from the air at 11:00: the row, the chapel, spruce stands, granite (helicopter hidden)

- Soft carved forms: a few big rounded masses, smooth Lambert shading, hard edges only on gear and buildings; clear silhouettes at phone size.
- Every material passes once through grade(): weathered paint, darks lifted to cold near-neutral (never black), greens toward olive.
- Cobalt zenith over a pale horizon, a hard warm sun, cold blue shadows, aerial perspective that pools in the valley.
- Patrol kit stays tomato red with a cream cross; orange-tipped poles mark every road.

NEVER: dark slate housings (#141C24) · Inter, Inter Display, JetBrains Mono · pure black · neon or toy-bright colour in the world · pastels on the mountain

SOURCE git history: #17 storybook direction, #33 Colorado high country (the world), #35 modernization · src/render/kit.ts grade()

COLOUR · THE INTERFACE

GENERATED FROM THE GAME'S CODE

Card stock, paper and signal

The interface palette, exactly as the game's stylesheet defines it. Names are the CSS custom properties; use the property, never a copied hex.

--ink
#3A2632 · Aubergine. Ink on paper; the deepest card.

--slate
#4A2330 · Burgundy card stock: panels, chips, the theme colour.

--slate-2
#5C2F3D · Raised controls on a card.

--paper
#F6ECDC · Cream paper: maps, primary buttons, tabs on.

--paper-2
#ECDCC6 · Paper in shade; the button's lip.

--text
#FBF3E6 · Text on card stock.

--muted
#E0BFB6 · Labels and secondary text on card.

--red
#D4422F · The patrol and emergencies; the act button in an emergency.

--amber
#E0B042 · Caution; who is speaking on the radio.

--cyan
#A9D6EA · Navigation; a chip that is on.

--green
#9CD1B0 · Done; good news.

--pink
#E7AAA6 · Blush: the default chapter tone.

--powder
#A9C8E0 · Powder blue: recon.

button text
#7B2F3B · Burgundy on paper buttons and the act button.

CHAPTER TONES · ONE PER MISSION FAMILY (.chapter.tone-*)

DEFAULT
#E7AAA6 · blush, 90%

RECON
#A9C8E0 · powder, 92%

AVALANCHE
#E0B042 · mustard, 90%

RESCUE
#9CC9B3 · mint, 92%

COMMUNITY
#B7A9D1 · lavender, 92%

RULES

- Cards are `--slate` on a dimmed scene (rgba 42, 22, 32 at 55%); never an opaque full-screen colour except a chapter card.
- Text on card is `--text`; secondary is `--muted`. Text on paper is `--ink` or the burgundy button colour.
- Signal colours carry meaning and nothing else. A decorative red or cyan is a bug.
- Chapter tones are the only pastels at full screen, and only for a moment.

SOURCE src/ui/style.css :root (read by art/bible/tokens.ts) · chapter tones: .chapter.tone-* in the same file

COLOUR · THE WORLD

GENERATED FROM THE GAME'S CODE

The mountain, as it renders

World colours are picked in src/render/kit.ts and pass once through grade(), the high-country grade. These are the values that reach the screen (before light), not the values typed in.

SNOW

- **Snow** #E7EBF0 snow
- **Snow in shade** #C7D0DE snowShade
- **Snow on roofs** #E8ECF0 roofSnow

ROCK AND STONE

- **Granite** #94908D stone
- **Granite, dark** #6A6764 stoneDark

TIMBER

- **Logs** #886C5C log
- **Logs, dark** #604B3F logDark
- **Logs, light** #A6907E logLight
- **Planks** #9C8165 wood

ROOFS AND STEEL

- **Standing seam** #464F4E roof
- **Galvanised** #9EA3A8 metal
- **Painted steel** #373B41 dark

THE PATROL

- **Patrol red** #C54137 red
- **Cross cream** #E2DFD9 white
- **Caution yellow** #CFA541 yellow
- **Brass** #BE9D57 brass

HOLLIN'S ROW

- **Barn red** #9B483C blush
- **Slate blue** #687C8F powder
- **Ochre** #BA8E47 mustard
- **Sage** #849685 mint
- **Weathered grey** #8B8E90 lavender
- **Oxblood** #6E3834 burgundy

FOREST AND PEOPLE

- **Forest-service green** #4C6A53 green
- **Soft-shell** #3C414B trousers
- **Pack** #4C545D pack
- **Lamp-lit window** #DFC8A6 window

THE WAY

- **Pole shaft** #383D45 poleShaft
- **Pole tip** #D38851 poleTip



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED

env-yard · the grade at work: weathered timber, forest-service green, cold snow

NOT GRADED: LIGHT, SKY AND MARKERS

- **Zenith, day** #2C68B8
- **Zenith, golden** #5A5F9E
- **Horizon, day** #C6D8EA
- **Horizon, golden** #F2B089
- **Zenith, night** #0A1022
- **Sun, day** #FFF0DC
- **Sun, golden** #FF9E62
- **Skylight, day** #9FBBE6
- **Beacon: active call** #5AD1FF
- **Beacon: waiting call** #F2C230

THE GRADE, IN ONE BREATH

- Lightness is compressed into 0.10 to 0.96: no black, no blown white.
- Saturation caps at 0.68; pale, chalky colours lose the most (x0.7).
- Near-blacks lean to a cold slate blue. Greens lean olive.
- Old storybook paints are repainted first: mint boards become barn red (the garage), raspberry becomes oxblood, teal becomes spruce.
- Sky, sun, skylight and the mission beacon are light, not paint: they are not graded.

SOURCE src/render/kit.ts PAL through grade() · src/render/rig.ts sky · src/render/worldView.ts poles · src/render/markers.ts beacon

TYPOGRAPHY

Three faces, each with one job

Jost speaks for the patrol, Courier Prime for people on the radio, IBM Plex Mono for instruments. Nothing else is set in the game or its materials.

JOST

Aa

KESSEL VALLEY

Geometric sans: titles, labels, buttons, the wordmark

- Wordmark: Bold 700, tracking 0.16em, cut across in two (see below)
- Panel titles: SemiBold 600 caps, 15 px, 0.22em
- Labels: SemiBold 600 caps, 12 px, 0.16em, `--muted`
- Buttons: SemiBold 600 caps, 13 px, 0.12em
- Chapter title: SemiBold 600 caps, 24 to 40 px, 0.16em

Jost 4.x (Google Fonts v20), SIL OFL 1.1. Weights 400 to 700.

COURIER PRIME

Aa

Kessel Patrol, it's Greta at the Kettle.

Typewriter: the radio, chapter sub-lines, anything said

- Radio subtitles: 13.5 px (12 px on phones), line height 1.35
- The speaker's name above it is Jost SemiBold caps in `--amber`
- Chapter sub-line: 13 px under a 46 px rule
- Sentence case. Never in capitals, never tracked

Courier Prime (Google Fonts v11), SIL OFL 1.1. 400, 400 italic, 700.

IBM PLEX MONO

0123

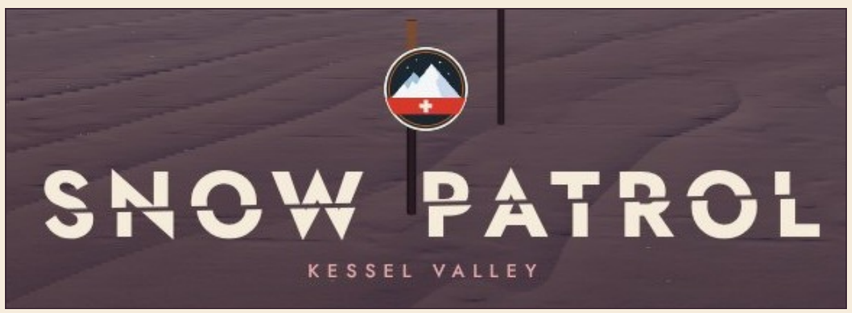
ALT 2,412 m -7 °C WIND 18

Readouts: altitude, numbers, stats, coordinates

- Altitude and small readouts: 12 px, `--muted`
- Map coordinates and debug readouts
- Tabular, never for prose or titles
- Medium 500 and SemiBold 600 only

IBM Plex Mono (Google Fonts v20), SIL OFL 1.1. 500, 600.

THE WORDMARK, AS THE GAME SETS IT



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED ui-title, cropped: emblem, cut wordmark, KESSEL VALLEY

- Jost Bold, tracking 0.16em, in `--paper`. Two copies of the word, clipped along a line that falls from 58% to 38% of its height, the lower half nudged 0.06em right and 0.05em down: a slide in the letters. SNOW PATROL stays on one line so the cut runs through both words.
- Above it, the Kessel Patrol emblem, clipped to its rim. Below it, KESSEL VALLEY in Jost Medium, widely tracked, in `--pink`.
- In a layout that cannot cut the word (a PDF, a share card), set SNOW PATROL in Jost SemiBold or Bold with 0.11 to 0.16em tracking and leave the cut to the game.
- Minimum sizes: 12 px for any text on a phone (PLAYCRAFT legibility rule), 44 px touch targets for anything you press.

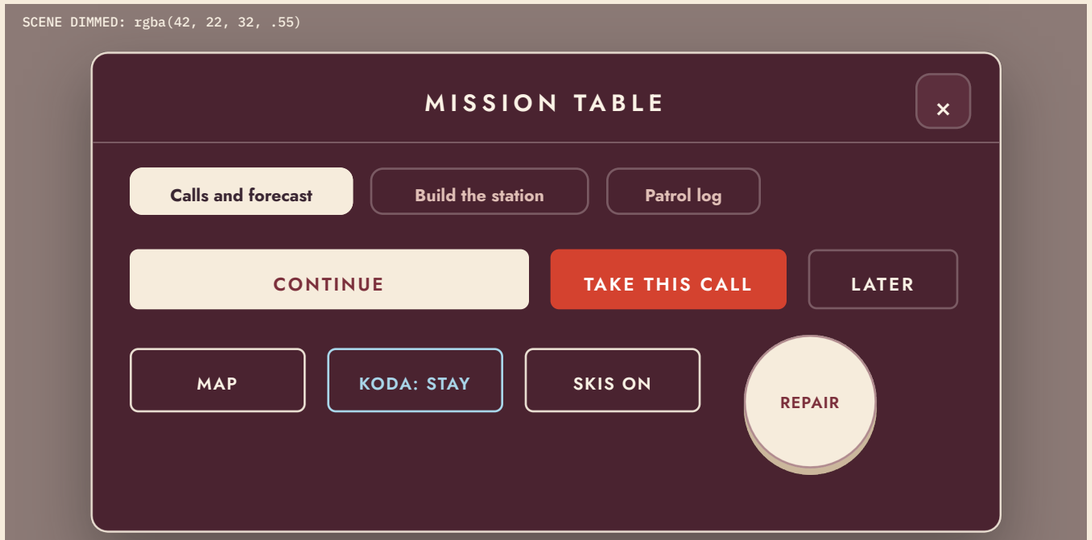
SOURCE src/ui/style.css (--sans, --type, --mono; .wordmark, .label, .btn, .radio, .chapter) · index.html Google Fonts · art/bible/fonts.json

SHAPES, BORDERS AND TREATMENTS

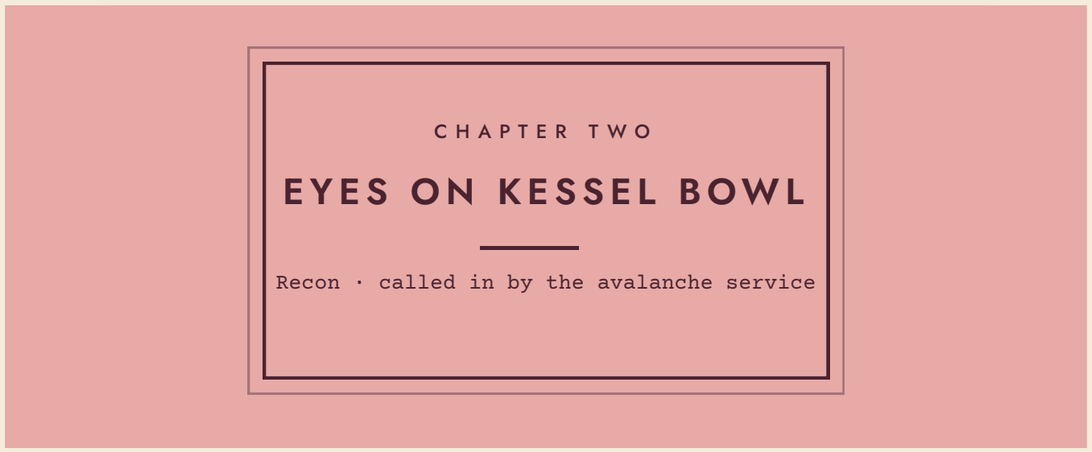
Card stock, cut and ruled

Soft corners, one thin cream rule, a deep soft shadow. Specimens below are drawn from the stylesheet's own numbers; the frames at right are the game.

ILLUSTRATIVE · NOT A CAPTURE



Panel 8 radius, 1 px cream rule at 45%, shadow 0 20 50 black 40%. Tabs 34 tall, 8 radius. Buttons 44 tall, 6 radius: paper, red, ghost. Chips 44, 6 radius (22, a pill, on a phone), burgundy glass at 74% over a blur, cyan when on. Act button 86 round (78 on a phone), paper with a burgundy inner ring and a 4 px lip.



Chapter frame: 1.5 px ink rule at 70% with a 1 px outline at 35%, 5 px outside it; kicker 0.42em, title 0.16em, a 46 x 1.5 rule, Courier Prime sub-line.



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED ui-chapter · a call accepted: the chapter card in its family tone

THE LENS: ONE GRADE OVER THE 3D VIEW (#grade)

- A cold, slight vignette (radial, to rgba 14, 22, 38 at 30%) and a cool-sky, warm-snow split, multiplied over the frame by the browser: no extra render pass.
- Fine film grain at 9% (an SVG noise tile, overlay).
- At night and in storms the lens closes in (#grade.dim).
- It sits under the interface: cards and type are never graded.

SHAPE LANGUAGE IN THE WORLD

Carved-toy primitives: rounded icospheres and soft capsules for people and Koda, eleven-sided drums, boxes for gear and buildings, cones for spruce tiers. Smooth shading on soft forms, hard edges where faces meet sharply, so figures take the same sun, sky and snow light as the terrain. No outlines, no glossy plastic; silhouettes carry the read.

SOURCE src/ui/style.css: .panel, .chip, .btn, .tab, .act, .chapter .frame, #grade · drawn here in DesignCraft from those values

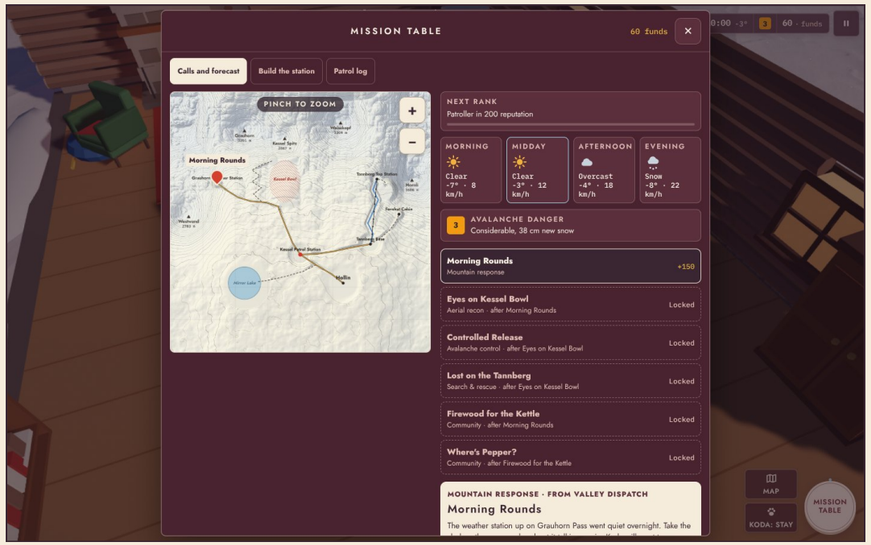
INTERFACE · 1

Title and the mission table

The title is a symmetrical, one-point view of the lodge front; the emblem, the cut wordmark, a few lines of copy and one red button sit in the lower third. The mission table is the day's plan on card stock.



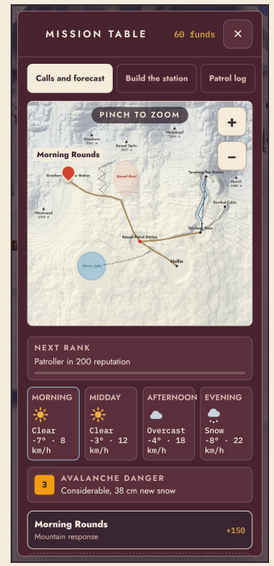
IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED ui-title · 1440 x 900 · first launch



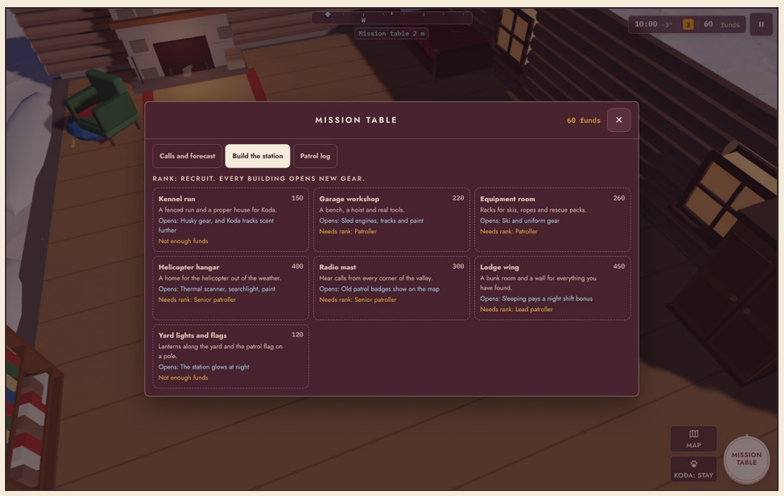
IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED ui-board · calls, the forecast in four periods, avalanche danger



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED phone-title · 390 x 844



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED phone-board · 390 x 844



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED ui-board-station · building the station

WHAT MAKES IT

· Title: the camera square on to the lodge door, Vince and Koda either side of it, a slow push in and out. In the lower third: the emblem, the cut wordmark, KESSEL VALLEY in blush, two or three lines of Jost, one red button (Start your patrol, or Continue).

· The table: one burgundy card on the dimmed lodge. Centred title in tracked caps; sentence-case tabs, paper when selected; a paper topo map; the forecast as four periods (sky, temperature, wind); avalanche danger as a mustard number and its name; the next rank above the forecast as one line and a thin mustard bar; the calls as cards, locked ones as dashed open cards with quiet text (never faded below 4.5:1 contrast); the selected call's brief on paper with a red Take this call and a ghost Free patrol.

· On a phone the card is one column that fits the width inside the safe area; nothing shrinks below 12 px; every target, the tabs included, is 44 px. Every card button lifts under a mouse, sinks when pressed and shows a 2 px cyan focus ring.

SOURCE capture.mjs: ui-title, ui-board, ui-board-station, phone-title, phone-board · src/ui/panels.ts board()

INTERFACE · 2

The HUD: as little as possible

A floating stick under the left thumb, look anywhere on the right, one big act button, a few chips. The radio speaks in a single line of Courier Prime.



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED ui-hud-foot · on foot, a dispatch line on the radio



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED ui-hud-sled · on the snowmobile



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED
phone-hud · iPhone-sized, upright



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED ui-hud-heli · the helicopter over Kessel Bowl

THE RULES OF THE HUD

· One act button, bottom right: paper, burgundy type, 86 px; red in an emergency. Hold to work (repairs, charges, first aid): a ring fills. Under a mouse it brightens and rises a pixel off its rim.

· Chips: 44 px, burgundy glass at 74%, a cream hairline; cyan when on. On a phone they are pills down the right edge above the act button, clear of the patroller. Map, Koda, Skis on, Get off.

· Top: a slim compass ribbon naming the objective and its distance; top right the clock and temperature, the danger number, funds and pause, in Plex Mono.

· The radio sits centred above the controls; toasts centred near the top in tracked caps (mint good, mustard warning). No minimap, no health bars: poles, beacons and the route line carry the rest.

SOURCE capture.mjs: ui-hud-foot, ui-hud-sled, ui-hud-heli, phone-hud · src/ui/hud.ts · src/ui/style.css .hud, .act, .chip, .radio

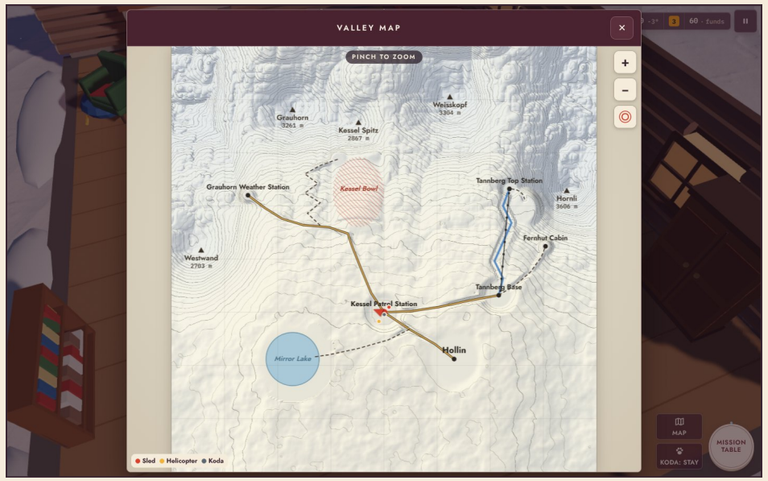
INTERFACE · 3

Calls, the map and progression

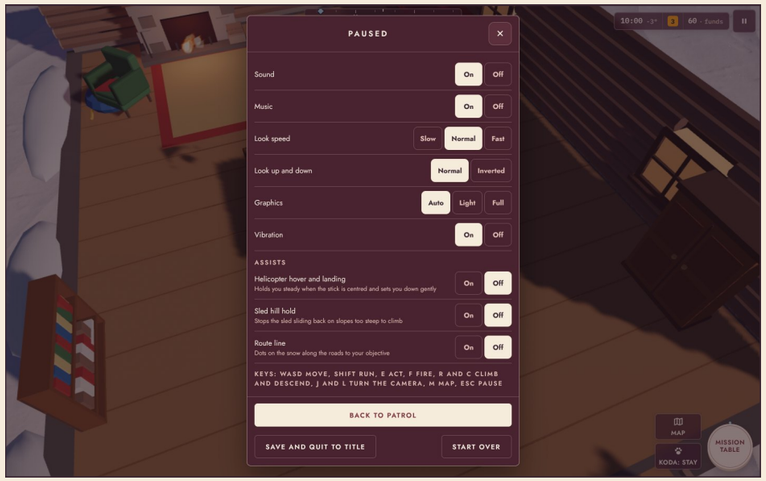
A call opens with a chapter card, puts a beacon over the objective and, if the player wants it, a dotted line on the snow. Progress is spent at the station.



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED ui-hud-mission · during a call: the objective line and the route line assist



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED ui-map · the valley map on paper



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED ui-pause · settings and the assists, all off by default



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED ui-wardrobe · gear, bought with funds and unlocked by rank

PROGRESSION, AS THE PLAYER SEES IT

- Funds and reputation after every job; reputation is the patrol rank. A rank up gets the stinger and a line on the debrief card.
- The station grows in the yard: kennel, workshop, equipment room, hangar, radio mast, the bunkhouse wing, yard lights. Each is a real building, not a menu icon.
- Gear for Vince, the sled, the helicopter, the skis and Koda: colours and kit in the same card layout, the price in the button.
- After the story Kessel Bowl reloads with new snow: a recon call and a control call share one pin, and a reward that depends on the result reads 'up to'. The next rank is always on the mission table.
- The map is a paper topo sheet on an 8 px card, pinch to zoom, paper zoom buttons on the 4 px grid; calls are pinned on it in their family tones.
- Every one of these is a card on the dimmed scene. No full-screen menus, no store front.

SOURCE capture.mjs: ui-hud-mission, ui-map, ui-wardrobe, ui-pause · src/ui/panels.ts map(), outfit(), pause()

PEOPLE · VINCE

Vince, the newest hand

Twenty, long honey-blonde hair with a bit of a curl, the patrol red shell. Cheerful and a little green: he walks like someone who has not yet learned to hurry on snow.



STAGED IN ENGINE · APPROVED

env-vince-front · close camera



STAGED IN ENGINE · APPROVED

env-vince-three · three-quarter



STAGED IN ENGINE · APPROVED

env-vince-back · the pack and scarf

THE SPEC

HAIR	Honey blonde (#E0C082), shoulder length: a ring of carved curls at the nape, locks over the ears, a fringe under the hat band. Always out from under the hat
JACKET	Patrol red shell (#CF4D41) with charcoal trim (#3C414C) at the yoke, cuffs and pack straps; a cream cross on the chest
SCARF	Forest-service green (#4C6A53), knitted, two tails on springs
HAT	Charcoal wool beanie (#3C414C) with a mustard band and pom-pom (#D5AF57); amber goggles (#D7A35E) pushed up on it
BELOW	Soft-shell trousers (#3C414B), gaiters, worn boots, charcoal mitts
PACK	Patrol pack with the cross; the old wooden tourers (#B79064) ride on it
BUILD	Soft carved, jointed: pelvis, two-piece spine, neck, shoulders, elbows, hips, knees, ankles; 25 bones in rs_patroller
FACE	Dark round eyes with a highlight, brows, a small nose, pink blush, a smile; he blinks

HOW HE MOVES, AND WHAT MUST STAY TRUE

· Feet are placed by a two-bone leg solver and stay planted; strides lengthen and the bob changes from walk (inverted pendulum) to run (spring).

· Hips sway over the planted foot and counter-turn the shoulders; arms swing with the opposite foot; the body banks into turns and leans into slopes.

· Loose things (scarf tails, pom-pom, pack) wobble on underdamped springs. Snow dusts whatever faces the sky.

· Always: the honey-blonde curls out from under the hat, the red shell, the green scarf. Those three read him at 40 px tall; the wardrobe may change the jacket and hat, never the hair.

· Never: a different hair colour or length for Vince, a hood over the hair, skis carried upright (they read as antennae), flat-shaded gem facets, outlines. Reference and marketing images show the default outfit (patrol red, charcoal beanie).

· New gear fits the same joints and pivots, in roles the mesh already has: the belt, first-aid pouch and sleeve cross added no draw calls.

SOURCE src/game/game.ts (VINCE_HAIR) · src/render/characterMesh.ts · art/3d/scripts/patrol_people.py (rs_patroller) · src/render/gait.ts

PEOPLE · KODA AND HOLLIN

Koda, and the people you help

Koda is a grey-and-white husky with one ear that has never once stood up. The villagers share Vince's skeleton but wear their own knitted cardigans.



STAGED IN ENGINE · APPROVED env-koda · close camera, Koda at Vince's side



STAGED IN ENGINE · APPROVED env-cast · lineup staged in engine: the game's own villager models moved into one frame

KODA: THE SPEC

COAT	Grey #6A737E saddle and mask over white #ECEAE5, dark #4A5059 points
EARS	Right ear stands tall; the left flops over. Always the left.
EYES	Pale ice blue #9FC9DD with dark pupils; open and shut eyes for blinking
FACE	Jaw, tongue, a pink inner ear; tongue and ears flop on springs
TAIL	Four segments that wag in a wave
GEAR	Red collar (#CF4D41) with a mustard tag; the patrol harness, saddle pack and bandanas from the kennel

THE PEOPLE OF HOLLIN

GRETA HOLM	The Kettle's landlady. Green cardigan #497952 with cream trim, a mustard bobble hat. Calls about firewood and Pepper the cat.
NILS	The Tannberg skier who gets lost. Blue #3C88BE with yellow trim, a helmet and goggles, red skis.
THE VAN DRIVER	Orange #D18547 with dark trim and a dark beanie; stuck in the drift by his van on the valley road.

- Villagers: a knitted cardigan with a Fair Isle yoke, a button band, ribbed cuffs, elbow patches, fur-cuffed boots. No shell, no patrol gear.
- Every person is carved like Vince, smooth shaded, and carries the same snow dusting. Each has one strong jacket colour so they read across a slope.

SOURCE src/render/huskyMesh.ts · art/3d/scripts/patrol_people.py (rs_koda, rs_villager) · src/render/missionProps.ts (Greta, Nils, the van driver)

PLACES · HOME

The patrol station

A 16 by 12 m log lodge with notched corners, a lean-to porch and a stone chimney, in a yard that grows as the patrol does. Walk in and the roof lifts away.



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED env-lodge-day · the lodge front at 12:00, interface hidden



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED

env-pad · the helipad and hangar

- Logs weathered grey-brown (#886C5C) on a fieldstone socle, end grain at the corners; the roof under a soft snow load that rolls over the eaves, icicles below (alpine_kit.py).
- Shuttered windows that glow warm (#DFC8A6) from dusk; a lantern by the door; on the yard wall the patrol plaque under a lamp, split wood and skis.
- The yard: the garage (barn-red board and batten on a concrete stem wall, cream trim, a timber-framed bay, stovepipe, woodpile, icicles), kennel, equipment room, hangar, radio mast. Buildings are built the way they would be: footing, frame, trim, overhang.
- Inside: hearth, mission table, bunk, wardrobe, armchair, books, Koda's bed, a hanging lamp.



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED env-lodge-inside · the dollhouse cut-away: hearth, table, bunk, Koda's bed



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED env-yard · the yard at 09:00: garage, kennel, poles

SOURCE capture.mjs: env-lodge-day, env-yard, env-lodge-inside, env-pad · art/3d/scripts/valley_buildings.py (rs_lodge) · src/world/station.ts

PLACES · THE VALLEY

Kessel valley, two kilometres of it

Hollin's working row, the Tannberg ski area, Kessel Bowl above the pass road, the Grauhorn weather station, Mirror Lake. Every road lined with orange-tipped poles.



STAGED IN ENGINE · APPROVED env-air-hollin · Hollin from the air: the row, the chapel and its onion dome (helicopter hidden)



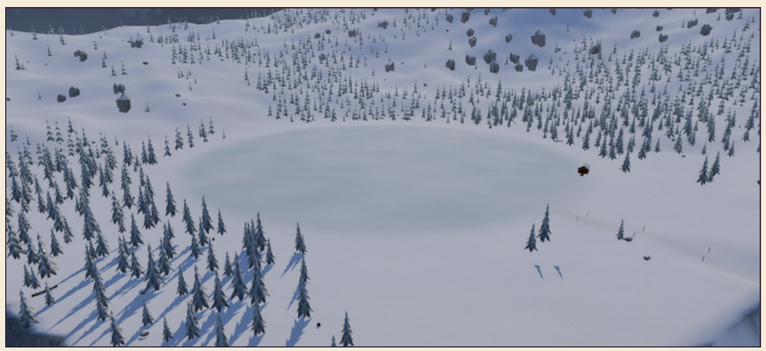
STAGED IN ENGINE · APPROVED env-air-tannberg · the Tannberg: base lodge, the chairlift, the run (helicopter hidden)



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED env-hollin · on the ground in Hollin: the Kettle



STAGED IN ENGINE · APPROVED env-air-bowl · the open track of the Kessel Bowl avalanche path, fences on the ridge



STAGED IN ENGINE · APPROVED env-air-lake · Mirror Lake, frozen

- The ground knows what it is: packed (roads, pistes, yards), powder, wind crust on the steeps, lake ice.
- Exposed granite from about 30 degrees and on wind-scoured crests, snow clinging in streaks down the fall line.
- A real avalanche operation: snow fences, remote exploders on Kessel Ridge, warning signs where the road crosses the runout, an old silver-mine headframe.
- Engelmann blue-green spruce in stands, snow-capped on the broad lower tiers; the eroded range rising 2 to 5 km out.

SOURCE capture.mjs: env-air-hollin, env-air-tannberg, env-hollin, env-air-bowl, env-air-lake · src/world/places.ts · art/3d/scripts/working_mountain.py

LIGHT

Light through the day

06:00 to 22:00 in about twenty minutes. One camera on the lodge front, four times of day: these frames are the reference for any lighting change.

06:40 DAWN



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED

env-lodge-dawn · low sun, long blue shadows, windows still lit

12:00 DAY



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED

env-lodge-day · cream snow in the sun, cobalt in the shade

18:40 DUSK



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED

env-lodge-dusk · the evening snow begins; window light on the snow

21:30 NIGHT



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED

env-lodge-night · moonlit snow, lamplight, Vince still reads

THE SKY RAMP (src/render/rig.ts)

ZENITH		night #0A1022 · day #2C68B8 · golden #5A5F9E
HORIZON		night #1A2140 · day #C6D8EA · golden #F2B089
SUN		night #9FB4E8 · day #FFF0DC · golden #FF9E62

night -> day; golden-hour tint at right (blended in at the ends of the day)

· Field Guide Alpine: cold world, warm people. Warmth comes only from what people made: windows, lamps, the headlamp, patrol red.

· Snow is never white: sunlight on it leans cream (peach at golden hour), skylight in its shade cobalt-violet (fieldGuide.ts SNOW_LIGHT).

· The surround is three ridge bands, timbered foothills, a serrated range, separate summits, each a step further into the haze.

· Night is dark but the people read: a cold moon on the snow, a cold fill and sky rim on figures, window light thrown on the snow.

· Aerial perspective, not fog. The amber column is the beacon of a call waiting at the lodge.

SOURCE capture.mjs: env-lodge-dawn, -day, -dusk, -night (one camera, four times) · src/render/rig.ts (sky, sun, hemisphere, fog)

WEATHER AND AIR

Clear, overcast, snow, storm

The forecast has four periods a day and blends between them. Snow thickens the air and fills tracks in; a storm grounds the helicopter and closes the lens.

CLEAR



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED

env-lodge-day · day 1, 12:00

OVERCAST



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED

env-overcast · day 1, 15:30

SNOW



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED

env-snow · day 30, 08:00 (forecast: snow)

STORM



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED

env-storm · day 30, 12:00 (forecast: storm)

- Wind is visible: grains and wisps stream past at boot height, spindrift tears off the summits, the camera breathes more on an exposed day.
- Snowfall is particles that thicken with the forecast; tracks from boots, the sled and skis fill in faster while it falls.
- Sky values per state (weather.ts): cloud 0.05 / 0.7 / 0.85 / 1, fog 0 / 0.25 / 0.5 / 1 for clear, overcast, snow, storm.
- Effects: powder puff, powder burst, the charge blast and the hearth fire share one flipbook atlas (public/fx/kessel-fx.png).
- The avalanche itself: a slab released from the start zone under the cornice, a powder cloud, debris that settles into the runout.
- Weather never changes the interface's colours; only the lens grade (#grade.dim) responds.

THE FORECAST, AS THE PLAYER READS IT



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED

ui-board, cropped: the four periods with sky, temperature and wind

SOURCE capture.mjs: env-lodge-day, env-overcast, env-snow, env-storm (day 30 forecast) · src/world/weather.ts · src/render/atmosphere.ts

MARKERS, WAYFINDING AND MACHINES

How the world shows the way

Information lives in the world: poles you can follow in a whiteout, a beam of light over where you are needed, the patrol's machines in patrol red.



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED env-lodge-dusk · a call waiting: the amber beam over the lodge (cyan once accepted)



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED env-ops-sign · AVALANCHE AREA where the road crosses the runout



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED ui-hud-mission · the route line on the snow and the cyan beacon of an accepted call



STAGED IN ENGINE · APPROVED env-sled · the snowmobile, Koda on the rack (close camera)



IN-GAME CAPTURE · APPROVED env-heli · the rescue helicopter in flight

· Snow poles: dark #383D45 shafts with an orange tip (#D38851, picked as #FF7A1A), along every road and track, about 1.6 m tall.

· Beacon: a soft vertical beam and a ground ring. Amber #F2C230 for a call waiting, cyan #5AD1FF for the active objective. Additive, never graded.

· Route line (assist): dotted along the roads to the objective, on the snow, not on the screen.

· Machines: the snowmobile and helicopter carry the patrol red and cream cross; the helicopter is SKYTRACE's. The sled shows how it works: bogie wheels, coil-overs, strapped bags.

SOURCE capture.mjs: env-lodge-dusk, env-ops-sign, ui-hud-mission, env-sled, env-heli · src/render/markers.ts · src/render/worldView.ts snow poles

IDENTITY

The emblem and the share card

The Kessel Patrol patch is the one mark. It is a patch, so it keeps its own colours wherever it goes; the share card shows how it sits on card stock.



SHIPPED ASSET · APPROVED public/icons/icon-512.png, clipped to its rim



SHIPPED ASSET · APPROVED public/og-image.jpg · 1200 x 630 · the link preview

· The patch: a white peak on a dark ground, a pole-orange inner ring, a cream rim, the red band with the cream cross. Shown clipped to its rim; never the square tile.

· Its dark ground is the patch's own: it is not a licence to use dark slate anywhere else.

· Minimum size 32 px (favicon). Do not recolour, outline, rotate or put type inside it.

· Share card: aubergine card stock, an inset 1.5 pt cream rule, the emblem, SNOW PATROL in Jost SemiBold, KESSEL VALLEY in blush, Courier Prime copy, a mustard URL line, the lodge at dusk fading in from the right.

· Any new marketing image follows the same build: a real capture, a card-stock panel, the three faces.

SOURCE public/icons/icon.svg (VectorCraft) · public/og-image.jpg (DesignCraft, art/pipeline/4_share_card.py)

FOR ANYTHING NEW

The checklist, and what must not come back

Run a new asset, screen or document through these before it ships. Anything on the right is a regression, whatever else is good about it.

NEW WORK MUST

- ☐ **LAYER** Belong to one layer: storybook interface or high-country world. Never mix them.
- ☐ **COLOUR** Interface: only the CSS tokens on page 4. World: palette roles picked in kit.ts and passed through grade() (page 5).
- ☐ **TYPE** Jost, Courier Prime or IBM Plex Mono, in the jobs on page 6. 12 px minimum on a phone.
- ☐ **SHAPE** Cards: 8 radius, 1 px cream rule, the soft deep shadow. 44 px touch targets. World: soft carved figures, built buildings on a stone socle, snow as a soft load (never a slab), no outlines.
- ☐ **PEOPLE** Fit the 25-bone patroller or 21-bone Koda skeleton at the code's pivots; Vince keeps his hair, shell and scarf.
- ☐ **LIGHT** Look right at 06:40, 12:00, 18:40 and 21:30 and in a storm (pages 15 and 16).
- ☐ **PROOF** Be checked in the running game: a capture at 1440 x 900 and on a 390 x 844 phone.

HOW TO RUN A REVIEW

1. Build the change and capture it the way this book does: node art/bible/capture.mjs (add a staged view if it needs one).
2. Put the frames beside the page that covers them; check colour, type, shape, people and light against it.
3. npx vitest run tests/art-direction.test.ts: tokens and rendered colours still match this book; nothing retired is back.
4. If the change is meant to move the look, rebuild this book in the same pull request.

RETIRED IN EDITION 2

RETIRED · DO NOT USE

#141C24 #1D2731 #F1ECE1 #FF7A1A #9FB0BF

Edition 1's slate ink #141C24 and #1D2731, paper #F1ECE1, orange #FF7A1A as an interface colour and muted #9FB0BF. (#FF7A1A survives only as the pole tip's picked colour, graded to #D38851, and in the emblem's ring.)

- × **Dark slate instrument housings**
  panels and cards in #141C24 / #1D2731
- × **Inter, Inter Display, JetBrains Mono, Archivo**
  edition 1's faces and the pre-#17 game's; the game has set Jost since #17
- × **The plum print grade**
  replaced by the lens grade in #33
- × **Raspberry lodge, pastel Hollin, teal spruce**
  the storybook world; now oxblood, weathered timber and the barn-red row
- × **'Lit like a clear winter morning, flat palette colour'**
  now: a hard sun, cold skylight, aerial perspective
- × **The ten-piece kit sheet as the art bible**
  the kit is still in the game, but it is not the direction
- × **Pure black, pure white, neon**
  grade() makes them impossible in the world; keep them out of the interface

Found a difference between this book and the game? The game is right. Capture it, fix the book's source (art/bible/), rebuild, and say what changed in the pull request.

SOURCE this page is the review checklist for DesignCraft, PixelCraft and Claude Code work · tests/art-direction.test.ts guards the retired tokens

HOW THIS BOOK IS MADE

Sources and how to rebuild

Nothing here is pasted by hand. Rebuild it whenever the game changes, and commit the captures, the layout and the PDF together.

```
npm ci && npx vite build
npx vite preview --port 4173 &
node art/bible/capture.mjs
npx tsx art/bible/tokens.ts > art/bible/tokens.json
python3 art/bible/build_bible.py
```

`capture.mjs`	Playwright and the game's QA handle (window.patrol): every frame staged, the interface hidden for env shots. shots.json records each one.
`tokens.ts`	Reads src/ui/style.css, src/render/kit.ts (through grade()) and src/render/rig.ts into tokens.json. Colour values in this book come only from there.
`build_bible.py`	Drives GITCRAFT DesignCraft headless through GITCRAFT's guard and sandbox; fonts from fonts.json, pinned by SHA-256; fails on a missing font, overset text or a missing capture; exports this PDF and renders every page for review.
`kessel-art-bible.designcraft`	The editable layout (art/bible/). Open it beside a Document Fonts folder holding the fonts in fonts.json.
`QA.md`	The page-by-page review of this edition.

Pages: 20
Captures: 41 (27 interface hidden, 14 with interface)
Fonts: 9 files, SIL OFL 1.1
DesignCraft commands: 4918
Built: 2026-11-09
Game build: 591e565

Fonts: Jost, Courier Prime, IBM Plex Mono (Google Fonts). Rock and snow relief in the captures: Poly Haven CC0 scans (CREDITS.md). Everything else in the game and in this book is made in this repository or with GITCRAFT.